welcome

Thank you for purchasing the MEAP edition of *Authorization in Action*. I'm excited to share this journey with you as we explore one of the most important and fastest growing areas in digital identity.

This book is written for identity architects, application developers, product managers, and IT professionals who already have some experience with authentication and access control but want to explore the design and implementation of dynamic authorization more deeply. You don't need to be an expert in policy languages or authorization engines, but a working knowledge of identity systems and basic software architecture will help you maximize the benefits of this book.

Dynamic authorization based on policies enables organizations to make access decisions in real-time, leveraging live data about people, devices, resources, and their connections. This approach moves beyond static roles and permissions, enabling fine-grained, just-in-time access that adapts as business needs evolve. It's a major change, and it's reshaping how systems are designed and managed.

Throughout the book, we'll use the fictional but realistic ACME Corp case study to ground our discussions. You'll see how different models—role-based, attribute-based, and relationship-based access control—work together, how to design effective policies, and how to incorporate them into your architecture. You'll also learn about governance structures, team roles, and architectural patterns that support sustainable dynamic authorization in the real world. And yes, we'll get hands-on with Cedar, a modern policy language, so you can put these concepts into practice right away.

Since you're reading the MEAP edition, you'll receive chapters as they are finished and your feedback will influence the final book. If something isn't clear, or you believe there's a better example or explanation, please share it in the liveBook discussion forum. Your input will help make this a stronger, more helpful resource for everyone.